

## Samsung SGH-E530

In keeping with its lifestyle image, Samsung has introduced the SGH-E530, a clamshell GSM phone targeted primarily at women. Sporting lavender pink shades and an extremely compact, elegant oval design, the phone will fit perfectly even in skin-tight jean pockets. It weighs just 85 grams and measures 86 x 43 x 26 mm, so it can also be strung around your neck.

The internal LCD is 262K, while the external OLED screen is 65K. Other key features include an integrated 1-megapixel camera with flash and 4X digital zoom, an MP3 player, 64-polyphonic ringtones, 1-hour video recording, and a phonebook capacity of 1,000 contacts. Connectivity options include GPRS and Bluetooth. The internal 90 MB memory is shared between applications and, sadly, there is no option to expand this. Another feature lacking is FM radio.

Other aspects that will appeal to women are calculators for biorhythm and height/weight ratio, a calorie counter, a pink scheduler, and shopping list functions.

The screen is extremely crisp and vibrant. Voice clarity is clear, but network reception needs improvement. Images captured in good light turn out pretty decent. Overall, the E530 will surely appeal to the fashion-conscious.

Company **Samsung India Electronics Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 15,299**

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Rating 



## Apple iPod nano

### Thinner Than Thin!

Here comes another iPod—the iPod nano. It uses Flash memory, is available in 2 and 4 GB versions, and comes in black as well as white. Measuring 3.5 x 1.6 x 0.27 inches (yes, it's a quarter of an inch thick!) and weighing 42 grams, the nano is something like a credit card. Pictures just do not do it justice—you have to hold it to believe it!

Features include a 1.5-inch backlit colour 176 x 132 LCD, touch-sensitive click wheel, and support for a variety of audio formats. It also supports photos, but no video, FM or voice recording.

The interface is typical iPod—extremely intuitive. As with the other iPods, the audio is excellent. The bundled ear buds produce crystal-clear music with good bass and almost no distortion at high volumes.

The colour screen is brilliant for menus, but too small for viewing photos. The battery is great—it lasted us about 12.5 hours of continuous playback at full volume.

Overall, there is really no need to upgrade to the nano if you already have a Mini, but it's a great buy otherwise.

Company **Apple Computer International**

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Rating 



## Adobe InDesign CS2

### A Fabulous Package!

One of the biggest advantages with using this package is how well it integrates with Photoshop and Illustrator, which, for all practical purposes, are the *de facto* tools of graphic designers today. PSD files can be directly imported into page layouts, and although Quark Xpress 6.5 has the same feature, InDesign seems to do this better. Its toolbar closely resembles Adobe Illustrator's, so veterans of these programs should feel right at home from the word go.

InDesign's flexibility can be experienced by the way you can create your own keyboard shortcuts to quickly access commonly used tasks. As an added bonus, users switching from Quark can opt to use the latter's shortcuts in InDesign, greatly easing their transition time.

Other notable features include a full-fledged implementation of layers, including letting you set the transparency of each layer to give you a whole new degree of control over your layouts. The ability to add effects such as drop shadows and feathers straight from within the program further adds to the feeling of completeness.

Talking about depth of user control over the page layout process leads us to the Separations tool, which lets you see the CMYK components of your page without having to undergo the pain of creating a PDF file and viewing the output separately. The icing on the cake, though, would

have to be the Ink Manager. By specifying the maximum percentage of ink your printing paper can absorb, you can scan your entire layout to see which areas will have excess ink, thus preventing the glossiness it causes. Control freaks have never had it better.

The package comes with a video workshop CD that quickly takes you through the steps of creating a document and using the salient features.

Before you grab a copy, however, make sure you have a powerful PC, because the system requirements on the box are a blatant lie.

To avoid pulling your hair out in frustration while you wait for the program to do its thing, make sure you have a CPU upwards of 2 GHz, and at least 512 MB of RAM. Not to mention, bucketloads of money for the program itself!

Company **Adobe Systems**

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Rating 

